

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, breezy, intervals of clouds and sunshine, high 50. **Tonight**, breezy in the evening, clear, low 32. **Tomorrow**, chilly, plenty of sunshine, high 49. Weather map, Page B8.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



NASA, VIA AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE — GETTY IMAGES

Approaching the Far Side of the Moon
The four astronauts aboard NASA’s Artemis II spacecraft have ventured farther from Earth than any other humans have. Page A16.

U.S. QUILTS DEALS ON TRANS RIGHTS

Ending 6 Settlements on Student Protections

By **MICHAEL C. BENDER**

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration on Monday terminated multiple civil rights settlements aimed at ensuring transgender students’ rights to equal opportunity to an education, forcing school officials to choose whether to comply with the government’s interpretation of federal anti-discrimination laws or abide by conflicting state statutes.

The terminations are an escalation of the administration’s efforts to enforce President Trump’s executive order that the government recognize only a person’s sex assigned at birth.

The actions show how the administration’s campaign to erase diversity, equity and inclusion policies has sharpened to root out specific civil rights protections, particularly for students participating in school programs or activities based on their gender identity instead of their biological sex.

The Trump administration has opened at least 40 civil rights investigations into educational institutions that provide protections for transgender students. It has also sued state education departments and high school athletic associations in California and Minnesota over policies that permit transgender athletes to participate in school sports. A total of 27 states have restricted the participation of transgender athletes in school sports.

Education Department officials said there was no precedent for the federal government terminating previously negotiated civil rights settlements with schools. Civil rights lawyers who worked under Democratic and Republican administrations said they were unaware of previous examples of such a move.

“To go back and terminate agreements and say all of the poli-

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World Is Perilously Low on a Lifesaving Weapon

By **NICHOLAS KULISH**

Since the start of the war in the Middle East, Iran has launched 23 cruise missiles, 498 ballistic missiles and a staggering 2,141 drones at the United Arab Emirates, according to the Emirati Ministry of Defense.

But the glittering towers of cities like Abu Dhabi, Dubai and Sharjah stand largely unharmed, and fatalities have been minimal. That is a testament to the effectiveness of modern military air-defense systems, which track and

Stockpiles of Interceptor Missiles Were Short Even Before War

target missiles traveling faster than the speed of sound and shoot them out of the sky with another missile, saving many lives and sparing homes and property.

The wars in Ukraine and now the Persian Gulf have highlighted the crucial role interceptors play

in protecting cities like Kyiv or Tel Aviv or Riyadh, not to mention American bases in Bahrain, Kuwait and other Gulf states. But the supply chain behind those interceptors has been strained for years, stressed by the war in Ukraine, past engagements with Houthi rebels along the Red Sea and last year’s 12-day war with Iran.

Missile defense experts are sounding increasingly dire warnings that if the war with Iran continues, stockpiles could become

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REUTERS

Manama, Bahrain, after an Iranian drone attack was foiled by an air-defense system last month.

When Live Nation and California City Clashed

By **BEN SISARIO**

The Irvine City Council meeting had one item on its agenda: whether to work with the giant concert company Live Nation to create a new amphitheater for the California city.

The proposed venue, a \$120 million undertaking, promised to bring world-class performances to the city of 300,000 about an

Failed Deal Offers Peek Into Antitrust Case

hour’s drive south of downtown Los Angeles.

City officials anticipated a project that would provide Irvine with millions of dollars each year through ticket fees and scheduled

payments by Live Nation, which would operate the venue and have exclusive rights to book shows there.

Among the many fans of the idea was Tommy Lee, the drummer of Mötley Crüe. “We need an amphitheater, a proper venue in Irvine,” he said in a video urging the city government to act. “Don’t make us go all the way to San

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NEWS ANALYSIS

After Dodging One Risk, Trump Takes On More

Effort to Hasten War’s End as Iran Digs In

By **DAVID E. SANGER**

WASHINGTON — After celebrating the remarkable rescue of an injured American weapons officer from his mountain hide-out in Iran, President Trump might have taken the hair-raising episode as a warning about the risks of expanding the war, especially as he considers possible ground operations inside Iranian territory.

After all, had Iranian forces found the officer, an Air Force colonel, before the C.I.A. and American special operators located and extracted him, the president could have easily found himself in the kind of hostage situation that, he often notes, ended Jimmy Carter’s presidency.

But Mr. Trump appears emboldened by the rescue, at least based on the obscenity-laced message he sent on Sunday via social media to an Iranian leadership that has refused to negotiate on his terms. Angry and frustrated, he appears on the cusp of another escalation, this time to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, where ship traffic was flowing normally before the American and Israeli attack began. Iran has discovered that this is its most potent bargaining chip.

Mr. Trump has now renewed his threat to bomb the country, and its surviving leaders, into submission, even if that means taking out the bridges and power grids that ordinary Iranians — including the current government’s fiercest opponents — depend upon for everyday life. And even, it seems, if such attacks raise the question of whether the United States would be violating the Geneva Conventions’ prohibition on targeting civilian sites.

“Tuesday will be Power Plant Day, and Bridge Day, all wrapped up in one, in Iran,” the president wrote on Sunday morning, as much of the country was preparing for Easter celebrations. “Open the Fuckin’ Strait, you crazy bastards, or you’ll be living in Hell — JUST WATCH! Praise be to Allah.”

Mr. Trump has never shied away from threats and occasional vulgar language on social media, but this post would have stood out on any day, much less on what most Christians consider the holiest day of the year.

It was notable for not only its language, but also its somewhat desperate-sounding tone. Senator Chris Murphy, Democrat of Connecticut, said on social media that Mr. Trump’s comments were “completely, utterly unhinged.” “He’s already killed thousands,” Mr. Murphy wrote. “He’s going to kill thousands more.”

Representative Don Bacon, a Nebraska Republican who is



KENNY HOLSTON/THE NEW YORK TIMES

TUESDAY DEADLINE As the president threatened destruction, talks over the Strait of Hormuz were underway. Page A10.

retiring from Congress, said in a text message that “Americans don’t want their president to be profane and vulgar.” He added, “Part of leadership is self-control.”

Obscenities and ultimatums aside, this was only the most recent example of how Mr. Trump has swerved from braggadocio about the power of America’s military to force Iran into “unilateral surrender,” to threats about new strikes against civilian targets if they did not.

In early March, a little more than a week into the war, he said the unilateral surrender would

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Black, Graying And Not Ready To Cede Power

By **ROBERT JIMISON**

WASHINGTON — Representative David Scott, the 80-year-old Democrat from Georgia, has not spoken on the House floor in more than two years. But when it came time in March to file for re-election for what would be his 13th term, he was among the first in line at the State Capitol, sitting in a wheelchair maneuvered by an aide.

Representative Al Green, 78, Democrat of Texas, generated headlines last year when he rose from his seat and shook his cane as he heckled President Trump during an address to a joint session of Congress. He, too, is seeking re-election after more than two decades in Congress.

And though the former top two Democratic leaders in the House, Representatives Nancy Pelosi of California and Steny H. Hoyer of Maryland, both octogenarians, are leaving Congress after this year, their longtime No. 3, Representative James E. Clyburn, the South Carolina power broker, is running for his 18th term at age 85.

Across the country, many aging Democratic members of Congress are stepping aside, heeding calls

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New Therapies For Joint Pain Show Promise

By **GINA KOLATA**

Three years ago, a little-known new federal agency announced its first big project: It would invest tens of millions of dollars over five years to find a cure for osteoarthritis, the painful wearing away of joints that affects 32 million Americans.

Now the agency, ARPA-H (the Advanced Research Projects Agency for Health), says it has several promising solutions. Its research teams are contractually obligated to start testing in patients within 18 months.

The new research focuses on knee osteoarthritis, but the investigators believe the solutions could eventually be applied to osteoarthritis in any joint.

Two research teams, at Duke University and at the University of Colorado, Boulder, have developed injections or infusions that regrow bone and cartilage, ARPA-H announced on Monday.

And a third team, at Columbia University, may have discovered a way to regrow an entire knee.

The methods so far have been tested only in animals. But experts said they were encouraged by the findings.

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Coping With Travel Costs
With gas at \$4 a gallon, some families are modifying their plans as the Iran war drives prices higher. PAGE A11

Bannon Crime May Be Erased
The justices agreed to clear the way for the dismissal of the conviction of a longtime Trump adviser. PAGE A14

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Influencing Hungary’s Election
Prime Minister Viktor Orban has hostility to Ukraine a centerpiece of his campaign. Moscow seems determined to repay the favor. PAGE A4

Epstein’s Ties to France’s Elite
In Paris, the convicted sex offender used a familiar strategy to achieve a veneer of respectability. PAGE A5

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Daily money managers often help seniors and the wealthy, but they’re also drawing busy professionals. PAGE B1



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The Guardian of Hermit Crabs
Mary Akers, a self-taught expert on the creatures, wants others to appreciate them as much as she does. PAGE D1

High-Level Research
How do you measure the depth of snow from space? First on the agenda: Climb to the top of a mountain. PAGE D1

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The Volcano Lover
Simon Hanes, a musician in New York’s downtown scene, has recorded a work for 15 musicians that touches on eruptions, Rabelais and Dante. PAGE C1

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The Crafter of a Hand Chair
Pedro Friedeberg, known for his hallucinatory canvases, cemented his fame with a work of art that was a pop culture curio. He was 90. PAGE B12

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David Plouffe PAGE A19



SPORTS B6-10

A Victory Born of Defeat
U.C.L.A. used a tough defeat in last year’s Final Four as motivation on its way to an N.C.A.A. title-clinching victory against South Carolina. PAGE B6



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